

DEFI PROTOCOL OUTREACH & MARKET RESEARCH

Target: 10 DeFi Protocols for MVP Validation

Goal: 3 Pilot Customers + Market Validation Data

MISSION CRITICAL

Timeline: Week 1 of MVP (4 days: Tue/Thu/Fri/Sat)

Primary Goal: Validate pain points, secure 1-3 pilot commitments

Success Metric: 10 conversations → 3 pilot customers willing to test MVP

Decision Point: End of Week 4 - Full commit to DeFi or pivot to ANREPORT

10 TARGET PROTOCOLS

Carefully selected based on: (1) Total Value Locked (TVL), (2) Active risk management needs, (3) Accessibility via Twitter/Discord, (4) Likelihood to adopt new tools

1. Aave

TVL	\$10B+ (largest lending protocol)
Pain Point	Liquidation risk monitoring, health factor calculations, interest rate optimization
Contact	Discord (Aave Governance), Twitter: @AaveAave, @stani, @lensprotocol team
Value Prop	Automated risk analytics reducing need for manual health factor monitoring

2. Uniswap V4

TVL	\$5B+ (largest DEX)
Pain Point	Impermanent loss calculations, LP position optimization, hook risk assessment
Contact	Twitter: @Uniswap, @haydenzadams, Uniswap Labs Discord
Value Prop	Real-time IL monitoring for V4 liquidity providers, hook risk scoring

3. Compound

TVL	\$3B+
Pain Point	Collateral risk, supply/borrow rate forecasting, protocol solvency monitoring
Contact	Twitter: @compoundfinance, Compound Discord governance channels
Value Prop	Automated governance analytics for risk parameter adjustments

4. MakerDAO / Sky

TVL	\$5B+ (stablecoin protocol)
Pain Point	Vault stability analysis, collateralization ratio optimization, DAI peg risk
Contact	MakerDAO forum, Twitter: @MakerDAO, Sky Protocol Discord
Value Prop	Risk parameter simulation for governance proposals

5. Curve Finance

TVL	\$2B+ (stablecoin DEX)
Pain Point	Pool imbalance risk, depeg monitoring, yield optimization for LPs
Contact	Twitter: @CurveFinance, Curve Discord, Telegram governance
Value Prop	Automated depeg alerts and pool rebalancing recommendations

6. Morpho

TVL	\$2B+ (lending optimizer)
Pain Point	Vault risk analysis, P2P matching efficiency, rate prediction
Contact	Twitter: @MorphoLabs, Discord (very active dev community)
Value Prop	Analytics for vault creators to optimize risk parameters

7. Lido Finance

TVL	\$20B+ (liquid staking)
Pain Point	Validator performance tracking, stETH/ETH depeg risk, slashing event impact
Contact	Twitter: @LidoFinance, Lido Research Discord
Value Prop	Real-time validator risk scoring and depeg event forecasting

8. GMX

TVL	\$600M+ (perpetuals)
Pain Point	GLP pool risk, trader PnL analysis, funding rate forecasting
Contact	Twitter: @GMX_IO, Discord trading community
Value Prop	GLP provider risk dashboard with automated rebalancing alerts

9. Euler Finance

TVL	\$200M+ (permissionless lending)
Pain Point	Long-tail asset risk assessment, vault isolation risk, oracle manipulation detection
Contact	Twitter: @eulerfinance, Euler Discord (rebuilding post-hack)
Value Prop	Risk scoring for permissionless markets, especially relevant post-exploit recovery

10. Balancer

TVL	\$1.2B+
Pain Point	Weighted pool optimization, IL in multi-asset pools, composable stable pool risk
Contact	Twitter: @Balancer, Discord governance and LPs channel
Value Prop	Analytics for complex pool configurations and weight optimization

OUTREACH STRATEGY

Week 1 Schedule (4 Days)

Day	Outreach Activity (Hour 3)
Tue	Initial DMs to Aave, Uniswap, Compound on Twitter. Join Risk DAO Discord.
Thu	Follow-ups + reach MakerDAO, Curve, Morpho. Engage in governance forums.
Fri	Contact Lido, GMX, Euler. Document pain point feedback in tracker.
Sat	Contact Balancer. Schedule demos for Week 2. Prepare pitch deck.

Initial Outreach Message Template

Subject: AI-Powered Risk Analytics for [Protocol Name]

Hi [Name],

I'm building an AI system that automatically discovers and validates risk formulas for DeFi protocols. It combines symbolic regression with LLM interpretation to provide real-time analytics.

Quick question: How does [Protocol] currently handle [specific pain point - e.g., liquidation risk monitoring, IL calculations]? I'd love to show you a demo of automated formula discovery in action.

Would you have 15 minutes next week for a quick call?

Best, [Your Name]

Follow-Up Message (If No Response After 3 Days)

Hi [Name],

Following up on my previous message about AI-powered risk analytics.

I analyzed [Protocol]'s recent liquidation events / pool data and built a demo showing how our system would have predicted [specific metric - e.g., the stETH depeg risk, high IL periods].

Here's a 2-minute demo: [Loom link]

Would this be useful for your risk team?

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

Ask these during initial conversations to validate pain points and willingness to pay:

Current State

- How do you currently monitor risk metrics? (manual dashboards, consultants, internal tools?)
- How often do you review risk parameters? (daily, weekly, monthly?)
- Who on your team handles risk analytics? (dedicated role or split responsibility?)
- What tools do you use? (Dune, in-house, consultants like Gauntlet?)

Pain Points

- What's the hardest part about risk management right now?
- Have you experienced any unexpected liquidation cascades or depeg events?
- How much time does your team spend on manual data analysis?
- Do you wish you had real-time alerts for specific risk thresholds?

Value & Budget

- If you could automate [specific pain point], how much time/money would that save?
- What's your current budget for risk management tools or consultants?
- Would \$500-2k/month be reasonable for automated risk monitoring?
- Who makes the decision to purchase analytics tools?

Pilot Interest

- Would you be interested in testing an MVP for free in exchange for feedback?
- What would you need to see in a demo to move forward?
- Timeline: Could you realistically test something in the next 4-6 weeks?

FEEDBACK TRACKING SYSTEM

Use this tracker to systematically capture feedback from all 10 protocols. Update daily.

[illegible]

SUCCESS CRITERIA

End of Week 1 (Day 4 - Saturday):

- ☐ Contacted all 10 protocols
- ☐ Received 5+ responses
- ☐ Documented 3+ unique pain points
- ☐ Scheduled 2+ demo calls for Week 2

End of Week 4 (Decision Point):

- ☐ 3+ pilot customer commitments (verbal or written)
- ☐ Validated pricing: At least 2 protocols willing to pay \$500-2k/month
- ☐ Documented product roadmap based on feedback
- ☐ Decision: Full commit to DeFi OR pivot to ANREPORT

BONUS: RISK PLATFORM OUTREACH

Beyond the 10 protocols, reach out to these risk platforms as potential partners or customers:

- **Gauntlet** - Risk consulting for DeFi. Could be partner or competitor.
- **Chaos Labs** - Simulation platform. Potential integration partner.
- **Risk DAO** - Community-driven risk assessment. Join as contributor.
- **BlockAnalitica** - MakerDAO analytics. Potential white-label customer.
- **Llama** - Treasury management. Could use for protocol clients.

IMMEDIATE ACTION CHECKLIST

Complete Before Tuesday (Day 1):

- ☐ Set up Twitter account optimized for DeFi outreach
- ☐ Join Discord servers: Aave, Uniswap, Compound, Risk DAO
- ☐ Create outreach spreadsheet with tracker template above
- ☐ Research each protocol's recent governance proposals
- ☐ Prepare 2-minute Loom demo showing MVP capabilities

☐ Draft personalized messages for first 3 protocols